

“Androcles and the Lion”

Androcles was a Roman **slave**.

When he was very young, his **master** took him to northern Africa. His master was a **cruel** man, who **flogged** him **mercilessly** and almost always without reason. Androcles hated his master and often thought of running away.

One dark, moonless night, Androcles left his master's house. Hiding his face in a blanket, he **crept stealthily** out of town. When **day broke**, Androcles found himself in a desert. After walking for hours in the sun, he came upon a **cave**. It was empty. He was thrilled to find a place where he could rest **for a while**. So **weary** was he that he **fell asleep** the moment his head touched the floor.

A little later, Androcles woke up hearing a loud, **piercing roar**. He jumped up with fright when he saw a huge, **tawny** lion with a thick **mane** standing at the entrance of the cave. Terror ran down his spine and he **shuddered** as he realized that the place he had chosen to rest was a lion's **den**. There was no chance of escape as the animal stood blocking the cave's opening.

Androcles waited hopelessly for the lion to **spring upon** him and was surprised when the beast sat down, **moaning** and **licking** its front **paw**. He noticed then that the lion's paw was bleeding **profusely**.

Forgetting his fear, Androcles went up to the lion. He saw that a huge **thorn** had **wedged** its way into the lion's paw, cutting it and making it **swell**. The lion **held up** its **wounded** paw as if it were **begging** Androcles to relieve it of its **misery**.

With a quick, **deft** movement, Androcles **drew out** the thorn.

“Ah, there! It's out! Now you **shan't** have any pain,” he said softly.

The lion **limped out** of the cave but returned a few minutes later with a dead rabbit, which it put down in front of Androcles.

“Thank you, my friend. How did you know I was **starving**?” he said and gratefully **set about** cooking the rabbit. When he had finished eating, the lion led him to a place where fresh water **gushed out** from a spring.

Overcome by the lion's **kindness**, Androcles decided to **break journey** and stay for a while with the **beast**. The two became good friends. They would **hunt** together and eat together. At the end of the day, the lion would lie down at Androcles' feet, **wagging** its tail from side to side.



Years **passed** and then Androcles began to get **restless**. He **longed** to get back to Rome, and one day, he **bade a fond farewell** to the lion and left.

On the way, he was captured by Roman soldiers, and taken to Rome as a **fugitive**. The ancient Romans were cruel to **runaway** slaves and Androcles was **sentenced to** death.

Androcles was taken to an **arena**, where hundreds of people had gathered to watch him get killed by wild beasts. The Emperor of Rome sat on a **dais**, surrounded by his **senators**. Everyone watched as the guards pushed Androcles into the arena.

"Here, take this to defend yourself!" a soldier **barked** into Androcles's ear, **whilst thrusting** a **lance** into his hand.

Androcles **trembled** with fear when he saw a lion being let out of a cage. The lion had been purposely kept without food for several days. With a **savage** roar, it **bounded** towards Androcles, ready to **devour** him.

There was a stunned silence when the lion instead of **pouncing on** Androcles, began to wag its tail and lick his hands. Androcles realized to his joy that the lion was his friend, from whose paw he had removed the nasty thorn.

The Emperor told a slave to bring Androcles to the dais.

"What did you do to the lion?" he asked. "How's that it did not kill you?"

Androcles told the emperor of how he had met and lived with the lion for three years. The emperor was touched. He **set** Androcles **free** and also gave him a **sack** full of gold coins.

Androcles lived the rest of his life in Rome with the faithful lion as his **companion**.



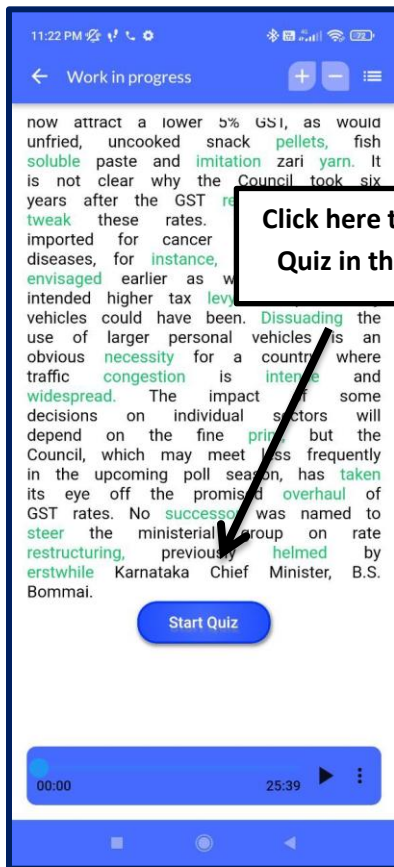
Vocabulary

1. **Slave** (noun) – servant, bondman, captive, drudge, serf – गुलाम
2. **Master** (noun) – owner, superior, controller, boss, overlord – स्वामी / मालिक
3. **Cruel** (adjective) – brutal, harsh, heartless, ruthless, inhuman – क्रूर
4. **Flog** (verb) – whip, lash, beat, scourge, thrash – कोड़े मारना
5. **Mercilessly** (adverb) – brutally, ruthlessly, pitilessly, savagely, harshly – निर्दयता से
6. **Creep** (verb) – crawl, sneak, slink, tiptoe, glide – दबे पांव चलना
7. **Stealthily** (adverb) – secretly, quietly, furtively, covertly, slyly – चुपके से
8. **Day break** (phrase) – dawn, sunrise, first light, early morning, crack of dawn – सुबह होना / भोर
9. **Cave** (noun) – cavern, grotto, hollow, den, shelter – गुफा
10. **For a while** (phrase) – briefly, temporarily, momentarily, for some time, short-term – कुछ समय के लिए
11. **Weary** (adjective) – tiredness, fatigue, exhaustion, drowsiness, weariness – थका हुआ
12. **Fall asleep** (phrase) – doze off, drop off, nod off, go to sleep, get some rest – सो जाना
13. **Piercing** (adjective) – sharp, shrill, penetrating, intense, loud – तीव्र / चुभने वाला
14. **Roar** (noun) – growl, bellow, howl, yell, thunder – गरज / दहाड़
15. **Tawny** (adjective) – yellowish-brown, sandy, tan, beige, light brown – पीले-भूरे रंग का
16. **Mane** (noun) – hair (of lion/horse), fringe, locks, tuft, coat – अयाल
17. **Shudder** (verb) – tremble, shake, quiver, quail, recoil – कांपना
18. **Den** (noun) – lair, cave, shelter, hole, hideout – मांद
19. **Spring** (upon) (verb) – leap, pounce, jump, attack, lunge – झपट पड़ना
20. **Moan** (verb) – groan, whimper, murmur, wail, sob – कराहना
21. **Lick** (verb) – lap, clean, caress, stroke, touch – चाटना
22. **Paw** (noun) – foot (of animal), claw, pad, hoof, forefoot – पंजा

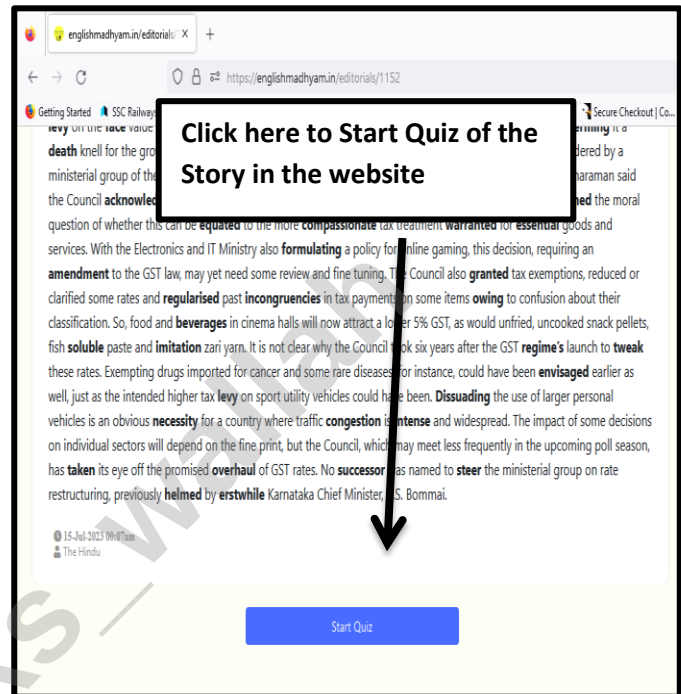
23. **Profusely** (adverb) – heavily, abundantly, excessively, intensely, lavishly – बहुत अधिक मात्रा में
24. **Thorn** (noun) – spine, prickle, splinter, barb, bristle – कांटा
25. **Wedge** (verb) – jam, lodge, insert, embed, stick – फंसा देना
26. **Swell** (verb) – enlarge, inflate, puff up, bloat, distend – सूजना
27. **Hold up** (phrasal verb) – raise, lift, display, show, present – ऊपर उठाना
28. **Wounded** (adjective) – injured, hurt, harmed, damaged, bleeding – घायल
29. **Beg** (verb) – plead, implore, request, ask, appeal – विनती करना
30. **Misery** (noun) – suffering, distress, agony, torment, hardship – दुख / पीड़ा
31. **Deft** (adjective) – skillful, quick, nimble, agile, clever – कुशल / चतुर
32. **Draw out** (phrasal verb) – remove, extract, pull out, take out, withdraw – बाहर निकालना
33. **Shan't** (modal verb) – shall not, will not, won't, not going to, refuse to – नहीं होगा (archaic or poetic form of "shall not")
34. **Limp out** (phrasal verb) – walk with difficulty, hobble, stagger, totter, shuffle – लंगड़ाते हुए बाहर जाना
35. **Starving** (adjective) – famished, ravenous, hungry, malnourished, underfed – भूखा
36. **Set about** (phrasal verb) – begin, start, commence, undertake, get to work – शुरू करना
37. **Gush out** (phrasal verb) – spurt, flow out, pour, stream, surge – बह निकलना
38. **Overcome** (verb) – conquer, defeat, overpower, subdue, overwhelm – पार पाना
39. **Kindness** (noun) – compassion, generosity, goodwill, sympathy, humanity – दयालुता
40. **Break journey** (phrase) – stop temporarily, pause travel, take a rest, halt, interrupt travel – यात्रा रोकना
41. **Beast** (noun) – animal, creature, brute, monster, wild thing – जानवर
42. **Hunt** (verb) – chase, stalk, track, pursue, search – शिकार करना
43. **Wag** (verb) – swing, shake, swish, flutter, move – हिलाना
44. **Pass** (verb) – go by, elapse, lapse, proceed, move along – गुजरना
45. **Restless** (adjective) – uneasy, anxious, fidgety, impatient, unsettled – बेचैन

46. **Long** (verb) – yearn, desire, crave, want, wish – तरसना
47. **Bid a farewell to** (phrase) – say goodbye, take leave of, part from, depart, see off – विदाई देना
48. **Fond** (adjective) – affectionate, loving, caring, tender, warm – स्नेही
49. **Fugitive** (adjective) – runaway, escaped, fleeing, outlawed, wanted – भगोड़ा
50. **Runaway** (adjective) – escaped, fleeing, absconding, missing, fugitive – भागा हुआ
51. **Sentence** (to) (verb) – condemn, punish, convict, penalize, order – सजा देना
52. **Arena** (noun) – stadium, coliseum, ground, amphitheater, battleground – अखाड़ा
53. **Dais** (noun) – platform, stage, podium, rostrum, stand – मंच
54. **Senator** (noun) – lawmaker, legislator, councilor, member of senate, politician – सीनेट सदस्य
55. **Bark** (verb) – shout, yell, command, snap, growl – डांटना / चीखना
56. **Whilst** (conjunction) – while, as, during, at the same time as, even though – जब तक कि / जबकि
57. **Thrust** (verb) – push, shove, drive, jab, force – जोर से धकेलना
58. **Lance** (noun) – spear, pike, javelin, weapon, shaft – भाला
59. **Tremble** (verb) – shake, shiver, quiver, vibrate, quake – कांपना
60. **Savage** (adjective) – fierce, wild, untamed, brutal, violent – क्रूर / हिंसक
61. **Bound** (verb) – leap, jump, spring, dart, lunge – छलांग लगाना
62. **Devour** (verb) – eat greedily, consume, gobble, feast on, engulf – निगलना
63. **Pounce** (on) (verb) – leap upon, spring at, attack, lunge, swoop – झपटना
64. **Set free** (phrase) – release, liberate, emancipate, discharge, unchain – मुक्त करना
65. **Sack** (noun) – bag, pouch, pack, bundle, sackful – बोरी / थैला
66. **Companion** (noun) – friend, partner, comrade, associate, ally – साथी

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